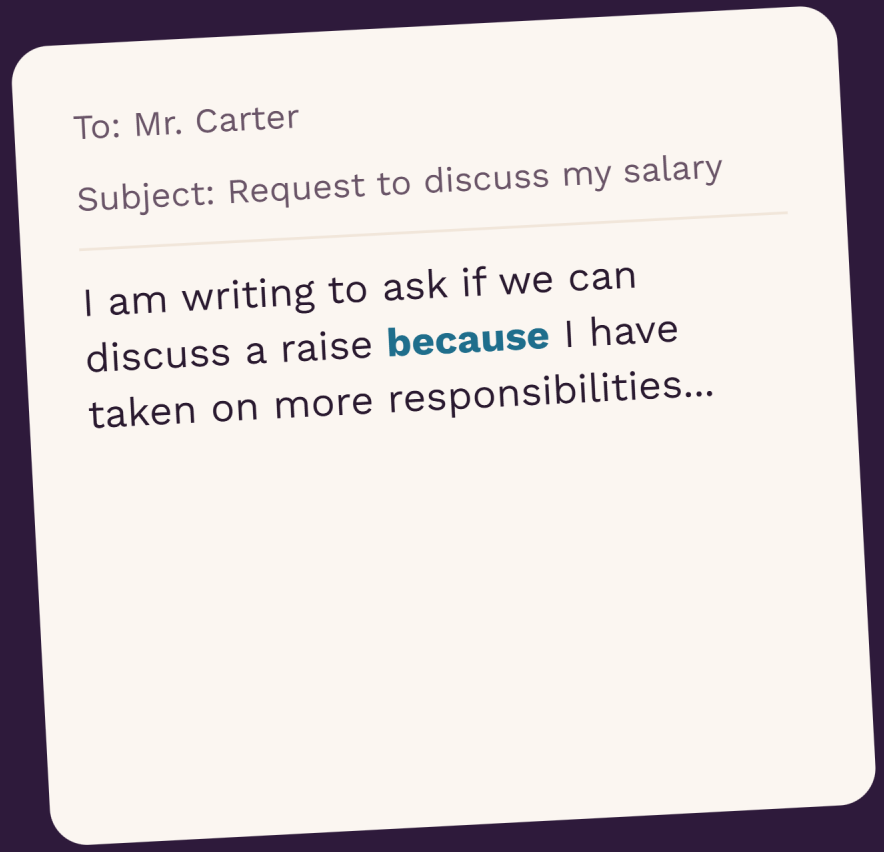
B2 WORKPLACE WRITING · 50 MINUTES

Asking for a raise by email

Clear, polite requests with because, although, and unless



TODAY'S GOALS

By the end of class, you will be able to:

Write a clear, polite email asking to discuss a raise

Reply to a coworker's request with a decision and a reason

Use at least 4 adverb clauses correctly

THE SITUATION

You have worked at your job for one year. You do more tasks now, but your salary is the same.

What would you do?

Whom would you contact?

What would you say?

QUICK REVIEW

Three kinds of adverb clauses

Type	Words	Example
Cause · a reason	because	I am asking for a raise because I train new employees now.
Contrast · the opposite idea	although, even though, while	Although the budget is tight, I believe my work has grown.
Condition · what depends	unless, even if, whether or not	I can work extra shifts unless I have class.

THE COMMA RULE

Where does the clause go?

AT THE START → COMMA

Although the budget is small, I have more work.

AT THE END → NO COMMA

I have more work although the budget is small.

MODEL EMAIL

Find the clauses. Name each type.

Dear Mr. Carter,

I am writing to ask if we can discuss a raise **because I have taken on more responsibilities since January**. **Although I know the company budget is limited this year**, I believe my work now supports the team in new ways. I am happy to meet at any time that works for you, **unless you are traveling next week**. **Even if a raise is not possible right now**, I would appreciate your feedback on how I can grow in this role.

Thank you for considering my request. Sincerely, Maria

Cause · **Contrast** · **Condition** · Polite phrases: I would like to… / I would appreciate…

YOUR TASK · 23 MINUTES

Write, swap, and reply

1. Draw a job card
2. Plan with the sheet and word bank
3. Write your email (4+ clauses)
4. Swap and review as the boss
5. Reply with a decision and a reason

COMMON ERRORS

Spot it, then fix it

Problem	Error	Correction
Fragment	I deserve a raise. Because I work hard.	I deserve a raise because I work hard.
Double connector	Although the budget is small, but I work hard.	Although the budget is small, I work hard.
Tense	Unless you will be busy, I would like to meet.	Unless you are busy, I would like to meet.
Tone	Even if you say no, I will quit.	Even if a raise is not possible now, I would appreciate your feedback.

HOMEWORK

Finish revising, then write one more email

Choose a new real situation: ask your supervisor to change your schedule, or ask your advisor for an appointment. Use at least **4 adverb clauses**.